

SABAL

ARECACEAE/PALMAE

Genus of evergreen fan palms, grown for their foliage and overall appearance. Frost tender. Prefers full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Water moderately, less when not in full growth. Propagate by seed in spring. Red spider mite may be troublesome.

S. minor (Dwarf palmetto) illus. p.457.

SAGINA

CARYOPHYLLACEAE

Genus of compact, low-growing annuals and evergreen perennials, grown for their dense mats or cushions of foliage. Suitable for banks and in paving. Some species may be invasive. Fully hardy. Prefers sun and gritty, moist soil; dislikes hot, dry conditions. Propagate by division in spring, by seed in fall or, for *S. boydii*, by tip cuttings in summer. Red spider mite and aphids may cause damage.

S. procumbens ‘Boydii’, syn. *S. boydii*, illus. p.376.

SAGITTARIA

Arrowhead

ALISMATACEAE

Genus of deciduous, perennial, and annual, submerged and marginal water plants, grown for their foliage and flowers. Fully hardy to frost tender. Some species are suitable for pools, others for aquariums. All require full sun. Remove fading foliage as necessary. Propagate by division in spring or summer or by breaking off turions (scaly, young shoots) in spring. **S. graminea ‘Crushed Ice’**. Deciduous, perennial, marginal water plant or bog plant. H 9in (23cm), S 6in (15cm). Produces linear, pointed leaves, marbled cream and green. Bears 3-petaled, white flowers, from early to midsummer. Z4–10 **S. japonica**. See *S. sagittifolia* ‘Flore Pleno’. **S. latifolia** (American arrowhead, Duck potato, Wapato) illus. p.434. **S. sagittifolia** (Common arrowhead). Deciduous, perennial, marginal water plant. H 1½ft (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Upright, mid-green leaves are acutely arrow-shaped. In summer, produces 3-petaled, white flowers with dark purple centers. May be grown in up to 9in (23cm) depth of water. Z6–9. **‘Flore Pleno’** (syn. *S. japonica*; Japanese arrowhead) has double flowers.

SAINTPAULIA

African violet

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rosette-forming perennials, grown for their showy flowers. Frost tender. Very closely related to *Salvia* and sometimes included in *Streptocarpus*. Needs a humid atmosphere, a constant temperature, partial shade, and fertile soil. Propagate by leaf cuttings in summer. Whitefly and mealy bug may be a problem for indoor plants.

African violet cultivars

There are over 2,000 cultivars, mainly derived from *S. ionantha*, with star- or bell-shaped, white, pink, red, blue, violet, bi- or multi-colored flowers, ½–2½in (1–6cm) across, borne throughout the year. Flowers may be single, semidouble or fully double. Petal edges may be ruffled, rounded, frilled, or fringed. The broadly ovate to ovate leaves are usually mid- or dark green, and may be feathered, flecked or variegated white, pink or cream. See also feature panel p.472.

Cultivars are divided into 5 groups, according to rosette size. The diameter of the rosette is the measurement given below; the spread of each cultivar is the same as this:
Micro-miniature—less than 3in (8cm).
Miniature—3–6in (8–16cm).
Semi-miniature—6–8in (16–21cm).
Standard—8–16in (21–40cm).
Large—over 16in (40cm).

S. ‘Bright Eyes’ (illus. p.472). Standard group. H to 6in (15cm). Has dark green leaves and single, deep violet-blue flowers with yellow anthers. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)
S. ‘Colorado’ illus. p.469.

S. ‘Crimson Ice’. Standard group. H 6–8in (15–20cm). Has dark green leaves and pansy-shaped, dark pink and white flowers. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Delft’. Standard group. H to 6in (15cm). Has dark green leaves and large, semidouble, cornflower-blue flowers. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Fancy Pants’. Standard group. H 6–8in (15–20cm). Has mid-green leaves and produces single white flowers with frilled red margins. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Green Lace’. Large group. H 6in (15cm) or more. Has dark green leaves and semidouble, white-flushed, pink flowers, with wide green petal edges, and yellow anthers. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Ice Maiden’ (illus. p.472). Standard group. H to 6in (15cm). Has mid-green leaves and single, white flowers with purple-blue markings. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ionantha. Evergreen, stemless, rosette-forming perennial, often forming clumps. H to 4in (10cm), S 10in (25cm). Almost rounded, scalloped, long-stalked, fleshy, usually hairy leaves, to 3in (8cm) long, are mid-green above and often reddish-green below. Loose clusters of 2–8 tubular, 5-lobed, violet-blue flowers, to 1in (2.5cm) across, are borne on stems held above leaves year-round. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Pat Tracey’. Semiminiature group. H 4–6in (10–15cm). Has dark green leaves and bears double, frilly-edged white flowers with a purple margin to the petals. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Powder Keg’ (illus. p.472). Large group. H 4–6in (10–15cm). Has wavy, dark green leaves and semidouble, deep red flowers, with white margins to the petals. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Rainbow’s Limelight’. Standard group. H 4–6in (10–15cm). Has mid-green leaves and bears single, lime-green and yellow flowers. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Rob’s Dandy Lion’. Semiminiature group. H 4–6in (10–15cm). Has leaves variegated, dark green, white, and pink, and bears cup-shaped, semidouble, white flowers. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Rob’s Smarty Pants’. Miniature group. H to 3in (8cm). Has toothed, mid-green leaves and semidouble, white flowers with ruffled, blue-speckled pink edges to the petals. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)
S. ‘Rococo Anna’, syn. *S. ‘Rococo Pink’* (illus. p.472). Standard group. H to 6in (15cm). Has mid-green leaves with light green bases and pale undersides. Bears double, iridescent pink flowers. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Rococo Pink’. See *S. ‘Rococo Anna’*.
S. ‘Sky Bells’. Semiminiature group. H 4–6in (10–15cm). Has mid-green leaves, speckled white along the edges. Bears bell-shaped, pale lavender flowers. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

S. ‘Zoja’ (illus. p.472). Standard group. H to 6in (15cm). Has mid-green leaves and large, single to semidouble, purple-blue flowers with a bold white line at the margin of each petal. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

SALIX

Willow

SALICACEAE

Genus of deciduous trees and shrubs, grown for their habit, foliage, catkins, and, in some cases, colorful winter shoots. Male catkins are more striking than female; each plant usually bears catkins of only one sex. Fully hardy. Most prefer full sun. Most species grow well in any but very dry soil; *S. caprea*, *S. purpurea* and their variants also thrive in dry soil. Plants grown for their colorful winter shoots should be cut back hard in early spring, every 1–3 years. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by hardwood cuttings in winter. Fungal diseases may cause canker, particularly in *S. babylonica* and *S. x sepulcralis* var. *chrysocoma*. Willows may become infested with such pests as caterpillars, aphids, and gall mites.

S. acutifolia ‘Blue Streak’. Spreading tree. H 30ft (10m), S 40ft (12m). Has slender, arching, blue-black shoots with a blue-white bloom, and narrowly lance-shaped, tapered, dark green leaves. In early spring, bears silvery male catkins, 2in (5cm) long, with golden anthers, before the leaves. Z4–9
S. aegyptiaca (Musk willow). Vigorous, deciduous, bushy shrub or tree. H 12ft (4m), S 15ft (5m). Gray catkins that mature to yellow are produced on bare, stout shoots in late winter or early spring, before large, narrowly ovate, deep green leaves. Z4–9
S. alba (White willow). **f. argentea** see *S. a. var. sericea*. **‘Britzensis’** see *S. a. var. vitellina* ‘Britzensis’. **var. caerulea** (Cricket-bat willow) is a very fast-growing, deciduous, conical tree with upright branches. H 80ft (25m), S 30ft (10m). Has long, narrowly lance-shaped, deep bluish-green leaves and, in early spring, small, pendent, yellowish-green catkins.

‘Chermesina’ see *S. a. var. vitellina* ‘Britzensis’. **var. sericea** (syn. *S. a. f. argentea*, *S. a. ‘Sericea’*; Silver willow), H 50ft (15m), S 25ft (8m), is a spreading tree that is conical when young and has bright silver-gray leaves. **‘Sericea’** see *S. a. var. sericea*. **var. vitellina** (Golden willow) illus. p.69. **var. vitellina ‘Britzensis’** (syn. *S. a. ‘Britzensis’*, *S. a. var. vitellina* ‘Chermesina’), has green leaves and bright orange-red, young shoots, and

is usually cut back to near ground level to provide winter color. **var. vitellina ‘Chermesina’** see *S. a. var. vitellina* ‘Britzensis’. **var. vitellina ‘Golden Ness’**, H 8ft (2.5m), S 5ft (1.5m), produces golden yellow winter shoots when hard pruned. **‘Yelverton’**, H 8ft (2.5m), S 5ft (1.5m), produces orange-red winter shoots when hard pruned. Z4–9
S. apoda illus. p.356.

S. arbuscula (Mountain willow). Deciduous, spreading shrub. H and S 2ft (60cm) or more. In spring, dark brown stems produce narrowly ovate, toothed leaves and white-haired, sometimes red-tinged, yellow catkins. Suits a rock garden. Z3–8

S. babylonica (Weeping willow). Deciduous, weeping tree with slender, pendent shoots that reach almost to the ground. H and S 40ft (12m). Bears narrowly lance-shaped, long-pointed leaves. Has yellowish-green catkins in early spring. Susceptible to canker and has been largely replaced in cultivation by *S. x sepulcralis* var. *chrysocoma*. Z4–9. **var. pekinensis ‘Tortuosa’** (syn. *S. matsudana* ‘Tortuosa’; Dragon’s claw willow) illus. p.80.

S. bockii. Deciduous, bushy shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Has slender, upright, gray-hairy shoots and oblong, glossy, bright green leaves, with silky-hairy undersides. Usually female in cultivation; bears green catkins in early and mid-fall. Z5–8

S. ‘Boydii’, syn. *S. x boydii*, illus. p.347.
S. caprea (Goat willow, Pussy willow). Deciduous, bushy shrub or tree. H 30ft (10m), S 25ft (8m). Ovate leaves are dark green above, gray beneath. Catkins are borne in spring before foliage emerges: females are silky and gray, males are gray with yellow anthers. Z4–8. **‘Kilmarnock’** (Kilmarnock willow), H 5–6ft (1.5–2m), S 6ft (2m), is dense-headed and weeping. From early to mid- spring, produces gray catkins that later become yellow.

S. ‘Chrysocoma’. See *S. x sepulcralis* var. *chrysocoma*.
S. daphnoides (Violet willow) illus. p.69.
S. elaeagnos (Hoary willow). Deciduous, upright, dense shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 15ft (5m). In spring, long shoots bear slender, yellow catkins as leaves emerge. These are narrowly oblong and dark green, with white undersides, and turn yellow in fall. Z5–8. **subsp. angustifolia**, H and S 10ft (3m), is a medium-sized to large, dense, bushy shrub, bearing very narrow, rosemarylike leaves, to 5in (12cm) long, with recurved margins.

S. exigua (Coyote willow) illus. p.112.
S. fargesii, syn. *S. moupinensis* of gardens. Deciduous, upright, open shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Has purplish-red winter shoots and buds. Slender, erect, green catkins are borne in spring, at same time as bold, oblong, glossy, dark green leaves. Z5–9
S. x fragilis, syn. *S. x rubens* (Crack willow). Deciduous tree with a broad, bushy head. H 50ft (15m), S 40–45ft (12–15m). Has long, narrow, pointed, glossy, bright green leaves. Catkins, borne in early spring, are yellow on male plants, green on females. Z4–8. **‘Basfordiana’** has bright orange-yellow young shoots in winter and long, narrow, leaves, gray-green when young, becoming glossy, bright green in summer. Yellowish-green catkins are produced in early spring.